

# Forgelane — reproducible build environments, defined once and run anywhere

## The Problem

A developer joining a team spends between two hours and three days getting the project to build. The instructions in the README are eight months old, the version of the toolchain that works is not the version documented, and one dependency only resolves on the machine of the person who added it.

Then the same problem reappears in CI, where the build environment drifts from the local one until a test passes on a laptop and fails in the pipeline for reasons nobody can reproduce.

## Our Solution

Forgelane is an open-source tool that defines a build environment as a single declarative file and materialises it identically on a laptop, in CI, and in a container.

The environment is content-addressed, so the same definition produces byte-identical toolchains everywhere. Switching branches switches environments. A build that works today works in two years, because nothing resolves at build time that was not pinned at definition time.

It is written in Rust, installs as one binary with no daemon, and works with existing package managers rather than replacing them. That last decision is why teams adopt it in an afternoon.

## The Market

There are roughly 28 million professional developers. Build tooling and developer environment management is a recognised budget line at companies above a few hundred engineers, and a growing one: the segment is estimated at \$4.1B and growing 18% a year as supply chain requirements push reproducibility from a nice property to an audit requirement.

## Competition

Two established tools solve reproducibility with a steep learning curve and a functional language most teams will not learn. Container-based approaches solve CI but not the laptop. Cloud development environment vendors solve both by moving development to a remote machine, which many teams reject on latency and cost.

Our position is reproducibility without the learning curve, and local rather than remote.

## The Team

Jonas Reuter spent seven years on developer infrastructure at a company with 4,000 engineers, where he owned the build system. Priya Raghavan maintained a widely used package manager for five years and was on its core team.

Nine people. Two maintain the open-source project full time, which is not a marketing cost — it is why the community is what it is.

## Traction

- 34,100 GitHub stars

- 9,800 weekly active installations, up 4x in a year
- 620 external contributors, 41 with commit access
- adopted internally at fourteen companies with more than 500 engineers, by developer choice rather than by procurement
- 2,300 people in the community forum, answering each other faster than we do

The adoption is real and it is organic. We have never run a paid campaign.

### **Business Model**

We do not have one yet, and we are not going to pretend otherwise.

The open-source project is and will remain free. We have started selling a hosted build cache to six teams for \$41,000 a year in total, which we set up by hand for each of them. There is no pricing page, no self-serve, and no second product.

The companies using Forgelane at scale are exactly the ones who would pay for support, audit artefacts and private registries. None of that is built.

### **Go-To-Market**

Currently none. Growth comes from the project itself.

### **Funding**

We are raising \$8M to build the commercial layer, which means we are asking to be funded on the adoption rather than on the revenue.